



shānti
yoga  teachertraining
school of traditional yoga

LEARN TO TEACH, TEACH TO LEARN

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WELCOME



If you are reading this message you have already taken the first step towards the greatest adventure of your life; the journey into self-discovery. Whether you want to become a Yoga teacher or you want to apply the ancient teachings to evolve your personal practice, you will discover this training is about your self – mastery.

When we came together to create the content for our school our main focus was to create a training that was accessible to all students regardless of age, skill level, or ability. Based on that philosophy we offer you an accessible, multi- style approach to Yoga that applies the ancient wisdom teachings to our Western culture.

Our skilled faculty of passionate trainers are devoted to your personal transformation and growth in a supportive and inspiring environment. You'll learn all the tools to teach Yoga and engage in a meaningful journey of self discovery.

~ Namaste

Uriel MacGillivray
Director, Shanti School of Traditional Yoga

COURSE OVERVIEW

This is a 200-hour Teacher Training Program that meets and exceeds the guidelines set by Yoga Alliance International. You will be immersed in the course over a month-long period during which time you will have the full support of the training of our faculty. In addition to the face-to-face training, there is a distance-learning portion to be completed within two months after the course is complete. The style of Yoga will be classical Vinyasa/Hatha. No prior training is required however, we do suggest that you have a regular Yoga practice and a keen interest in deepening your knowledge of the practice, history, lifestyle, and philosophy of Yoga.

Your training course will be guided by Uriel MacGillivray, Kyla MacKinnon, Nikki Martin, Stephanie Morton, and Kevin Dougall.

The course will take place in our beautiful and spacious **Dartmouth Studio**, located at **114 Woodlawn Road**. Our studio is designed to offer a serene and expansive learning environment. For your convenience, it is equipped with **full change facilities and showers**, as well as a complete **kitchenette** (including a microwave and fridge). You are welcome to bring your own lunch or take advantage of the **choice of several excellent restaurants** located nearby.

2026 DATES & TIMES

Module #1

May 1 | 5pm - 8pm

May 2-8 | 7am - 5pm

Module #2

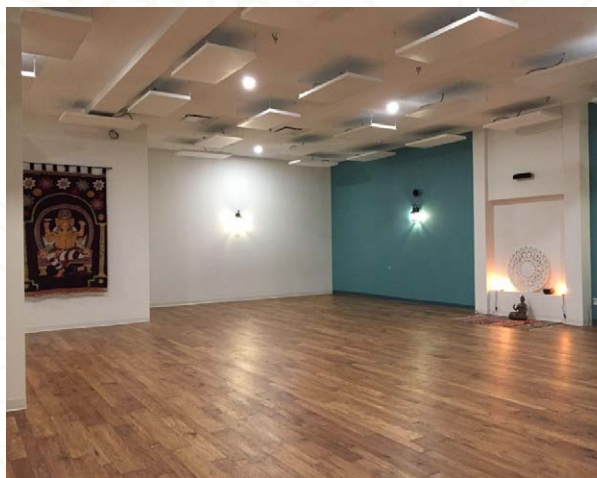
May 15 | 5pm - 8pm

May 16-22 | 7am - 5pm

Module #3

May 29 | 5pm - 8pm

May 30-31 | 7am - 5pm



TRAINING FACULTY

Our training course will be guided by **Uriel MacGillivray, Kyla MacKinnon, Nikki Martin, Stephanie Morton** and **Kevin Dougall**.



Uriel MacGillivray

Uriel is a yoga teacher, an entrepreneur, and a leader of transformational Yoga teacher trainings and retreats across the Globe. She is the founder of Shanti Yoga Studios and the Shanti Traditional School of Yoga based in Halifax, Nova Scotia.

Having held senior management and marketing roles in Corporate Canada for twenty years she answered the call to become a yoga teacher. A life-changing journey to India to study the ancient teachings would transform her life. Overnight she walked away from everything that she knew and started a phase in her life that would take her on the adventure of a lifetime. Stepping into her true purpose she recognized that students longed for the same deep transformation in their lives. Her studios and teaching philosophy are guided by the values of the time-honoured wisdom teachings of the Yoga tradition.

Led by masters such as the late Georg Feuerstein, of the Traditional School of Yoga and Suzanne Anderson on the Psychology of Archetypes, her main focus is to help students upgrade the way they lead, love, and live through the power of Yoga. My vision is clear she says: "I believe in the power of Yoga to transform lives and inspire students to awaken their soul's calling".



Kyla MacKinnon

Kyla is inspired by the act of leading others and empowering them to live their truth. She believes in the power of connecting breath and movement with those around her. Throughout her life, she has enjoyed coaching people and creating a space where they feel comfortable and confident in order to reach their full potential. From her 800 hours of

training, she vows to keep the tradition of Krishnamacharya's Yoga lineage alive thanks to one of her great teachers, Ryan Leier.

Kyla will incorporate a balance of strength and serenity into her teachings during the program. Her compassionate nature makes her a perfect fit as the YTT student liaison. She gives herself fully to new trainees who need guidance and support during the training.



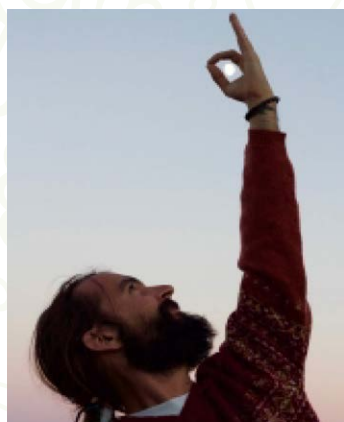
Nikki Martin

Nikki came to Yoga in 2011. Drawn by the strength, grace and challenge of arm balances and inversions, and a desire to finally forge a path to peace and happiness in her life. She quickly fell in love with the practice of Yoga as a whole and how it enriched all facets of her life, and though she still loves the physical challenges it presents her

practice is now driven by spirituality, philosophy, energetics and the powerful impact Yoga has both on her life and in the world. She has become a passionate advocate for diversity in Yoga and wellness and in 2020 co-founded the Black Wellness Cooperative, a not-for-profit that works to bring wellness resources to underserved communities. Her hope over the coming years is to be part of a movement making Yoga, fitness and wellness spaces more inclusive, accessible and diverse.

She completed her 200hr YTT with Shanti Yoga, the same studio where she was inspired by her teachers to deepen her practice and eventually follow her dream of becoming a Yoga teacher full time. Along the way she discovered a passion for teaching other teachers and helping them discover their own gifts and destinies along this path. Inspired to be more and to know more she has assisted a 200hr YTT to be certified as a Teacher Trainer, taken her Yin TT, attended various workshops and trainings in meditation, facilitation, and leadership as well as social justice issues with industry leaders. She has completed her 300hr YTT with Rene Quenell, in a Tantra lineage descended from the Himalayan masters. She is passionate about honouring tradition while meeting students where they are and brings a wealth of knowledge to each and every class along with her playful, creative and fiery teaching style.

As a writer and storyteller, she loves the idea that a Yoga class can lead you somewhere, that you can tell a story with body and breath and the energetic impact that results when they come together with intent. By sprinkling philosophy, spirituality and the 8 Limbs of Yoga into her classes in accessible ways she tries to pass along the greatest gift this practice has given her, "Ultimately this is a practice of connectivity. It connects us with the world. It connects us with ourselves. And it connects us with each other."



Kevin Dougall

A Yoga nerd at heart, Kevin brings his genuine passion for Yoga to every class. He started his Yoga journey at Shanti in 2011, and has since had the pleasure of training with Ryan Leier, Srivatsa Ramaswami (vinyasa krama), and Manju Jois (ashtanga), and holds a RYT 200, and RCYT (registered children's Yoga teacher) certification with Yoga Alliance. He shares his dynamic style of practice which is fun, inspirational, and focused on the core traditions of Yoga.



Stephanie Morton

Stephanie Morton has been teaching yoga since 2011. As a long distance runner and running coach, she has worked with many endurance athletes but also has a keen interest in yoga for healthy aging.

Her approach to yoga is pragmatic but grounded in traditional teachings and yogic philosophy. Her classes combine asanas and functional movement practices with pranayama and meditation techniques that support every lifestyle. She also specializes in pre and post-natal yoga.

Originally from Halifax, she recently returned to Nova Scotia with her family after having lived and worked in Playa del Carmen, Mexico for 15 years. She has a decade of yoga studio management experience and has been a lead trainer in many 200 hours yoga teacher training courses. She is passionate about supporting and mentoring yoga teachers.





200-HOUR YOGA ALLIANCE CERTIFICATION

While the face-to-face study will be completed on the dates specified there is a distance learning component comprised of two assignments. There will also be a final exam. The assignments and final exam will have to be completed by those students wishing to become a 200-Hour Yoga Alliance Certified Teacher. Some students will take the training without the intention of becoming a Yoga teacher. You don't have to make that decision upon registration. Our experience has shown that some students who had no intention of teaching changed their minds during the program. It's a personal decision in which we are here to support and guide you when the time comes.

The face-to-face training along with your distance learning assignments and projects will give you more than 200 required hours of total training. Our training model is one of a kind as far as completing your course in your home city in limited time while taking little time off work/school. Our faculty are highly trained having studied with masters of the Yoga tradition. Their commitment is to provide a top-notch training experience with individualized coaching throughout the program.



TRAINING PREPARATION

In order to prepare for training, we ask that you continue to practice Yoga (both on and off the mat)! Your personal daily practice before the training can vary and may range from 5 minutes to 90 minutes. Your practice could include physical asanas (poses), meditation, breath work, reading a Yoga book, a quiet walk in nature, eating healthy nourishing meals, etc. We ask that you come with an open mind and open heart.

Many people take the training to simply deepen their personal practice and expand their knowledge of Yoga. It is common for people to initially think they do not want to teach but that can change once they complete the training program. Whether you plan to teach or not, it is important to have an open mind and enjoy this wonderful experience.

The daily schedule will include 30-minute breaks for breakfast and 60-minute breaks for lunch during full day sessions.



COURSE CURRICULUM OVERVIEW

Module 1 | Yoga Philosophy

- The evolution and expansion of Yoga through the ages
- The rise of Hatha Yoga, its history and meaning
- The study of Samkhya Philosophy
- Descent from pure consciousness into consciousness; your journey from soul to manifestation
- The energetics of the subtle body and how it applies to Yoga practice
- The seven stages of Yoga practice
- Understanding Kundalini awakening
- The 7 Chakra model of the psycho-energetic body
- The Yoga Sutras of Patanjali
- Patanjali's eight limbs of Yoga and how to apply them in your life
- The alchemy of Yoga—Developing a personal practice of asana, pranayama, meditation, bandhas (energy locks), and mantra

Module 2 | Living a Life of Purpose

- An exploration into the purpose of life—your dharma
- A cornerstone of your training experience, “Living a Life of Purpose” is a life-changing process that integrates time-tested ancient wisdom to help you uncover the true purpose of your life. Based on Vedic wisdom, you will learn the methods to understand the Vedic way of thinking, questioning, and self-investigation so you can emerge with a new way of thinking and being that will positively influence your relationships, and careers. The application of this knowledge is very powerful in creating positive changes in your future.
- You will learn how limiting beliefs and habits prevent you from living the life you want. This work is truly transformational and will unleash the power of your soul to become who you were meant to be. It will show you how to tap into the power to thrive!
- The Yoga tradition teaches us that there are four great goals of life, also known as the four great Dharmas which are: purpose, prosperity, pleasure and freedom. These four aspects provide the roadmap to achieving your most fulfilling, meaningful and joyful life.

Module 3 | Anatomy & Physiology

- Introduction to Western approach to anatomy and physiology
- Overview of the systems of the body: skeletal, muscular, nervous, and circulatory system
- Experiential based workshops on anatomical connections and movement chains in the body relative to Yoga movement
- Common diseases, injuries, treatment, and prevention
- Introduction to Eastern approach to health and wellness
- The chakras and the subtle energy systems of the body
- Ayurvedic science and the relationship to Yoga

Module 4 | Technique, Theory, & Practice of Asana

- A deep exploration of the teaching techniques of the most practiced asanas (postures)
- Introduction to the Sanskrit language and its use in Western Yoga classes
- How to apply pranayama, meditation, bandhas (energy locks), and mantra to your teaching
- The energetics of mudras and how to apply them during practice
- Yoga Nidra – yogic sleep
- Expanding your personal practice to evolve your life

Module 5 | Theory and Practice Teaching

- The ethics of teaching Yoga
- The use of language, voice and style
- Demonstration and positioning in the classroom
- Learning modalities
- Sequencing a Yoga class
- Physical adjustments
- The use of props and modified versions of the poses
- Class etiquette and standard of conduct
- Challenges teachers face: injuries, psychological issues, other adversities
- The business of Yoga

Module 6 | Practicum

- Practice teaching: incorporating the basic elements of asana practice
- Observing others teaching
- Giving and receiving feedback
- Assisting a class while another peer is teaching

Module 7 | Distance Learning Projects

You will be assigned a distance-learning package to complete your training. The assignments are designed to give you an opportunity to integrate what you've learned.

You are required to attend all of the above modules except in the case of a personal emergency. During the weeks between modules, you will be given some light assignments and reading. Many students find this a great opportunity to practice and study together. Your peers will become a great source of support and friendship during this transformational time.

READING REQUIREMENTS

Required Reading List

- Heart of Yoga - T.K.V Desikachar
- Hatha Yoga Pradipika - Swami Muktibodhannanda
- Light of the Yoga Sutras of Patanjali - B.K.S. Iyengar
- Yoga Anatomy - Leslie Kaminoff

Please note that the required reading list (in particular the Yoga Sutras and Hatha Yoga Pradipika) are not books that must be read cover to cover. They should be examined for a basic understanding and foundation of the key principles of Yoga and will serve as a reference book down the road. The Heart of Yoga will be used for a book report as training homework.

Optional Reading List

- Light on Yoga - B.K.S Iyengar
- Bhagavad Gita According to Gandhi - Mahatma Gandhi
- Yoga Beneath the Surface - Srivatsa Ramaswami & David Hurwitz
- Krishnamacharya His Life and Teachings - A.G. Mohan

Additional Resources:

- You will receive a beautifully designed Yoga Teacher Training Manual.
- You will be invited to join our 2024 teacher training closed Facebook group, where you can make connections with other trainees, ask questions, and get support whenever you need it!
- You will be given a membership for both online and in-studio for the months of May and June, as part of your training. These bonuses are included in the price of your tuition.

REGISTRATION

To reserve your spot in the training, a **\$1,000 deposit** is required.

We offer an early bird rate **early bird rate up until March 1, 2026.**

The early bird rate is \$3,200.

The investment after March 1, 2026 is \$3,600. Payment plans are available.

FOR REGISTRATION VISIT OUR WEBSITE AT [CLICK HERE](#)

For payment plan options, please get in touch with us at info@shantihotyoga.ca.

Cancellation Policy: The deposit for this training is non-refundable. Participants who cancel will be given full credit for future training, including the deposit. Should Shanti cancel or change the dates of the training, participants will receive a full refund.

If you would like to arrange a **personal consultation** or require further details, please contact **Uriel MacGillivray**, the **Founder and Director**, directly at ujmacgillivray@gmail.com.

